

Possible Surface Interfaces



CLI



IDE

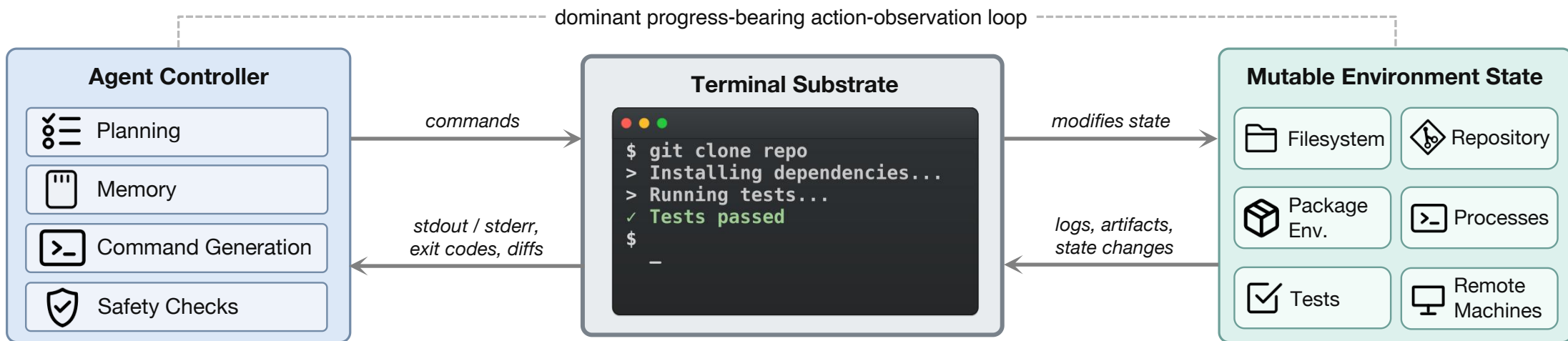


Web Console



Platform UI

surface interface $\neq$ execution substrate



Terminal agents are systems whose dominant progress-bearing action-observation loop is mediated by **terminal-based command execution**

Scope and Boundaries

In Scope

● command execution drives progress ● textual feedback informs next action ● stateful environment interaction

Representative Domains

Software Engineering

Operations

Data Engineering

Scientific Workflows

Cybersecurity

Cloud Management

Adjacent unless terminal-mediated

● chat-only coding assistants

● GUI-only computer-use agents

● CLI wrappers without terminal-mediated progress